

Childhood Wounds: The hidden force behind life's struggles

Whether it's self-doubt at work or struggles in relationships, the roots **often trace back to** unresolved childhood wounds

Have you ever **wondered** why life keeps pulling you back, no matter how hard you try to move forward? Maybe you find yourself repeating the same mistakes in relationships, doubting your abilities at work, or battling the constant **ache** of "not being enough."

It's easy to blame bad luck or personal failure. But often, these struggles run deeper—in unresolved childhood wounds. Childhood is when we learn how to love, trust and value ourselves. But not all childhoods are built on safety and support. Even seemingly small moments can leave deep **scars**.

A parent saying, "Stop crying, you're **embarrassing** me," or a teacher comparing you to someone else may seem insignificant at the time but can shape how we see ourselves for years to come. Take Radhika, for example. At 35, she **thrived** in her career but couldn't maintain a relationship. Every time someone got close, she would pull away, convinced they would leave her **eventually**. Therapy revealed that her **fear** of **abandonment** stemmed from her father leaving when she was six. Her emotional walls weren't about keeping others out; they were about protecting herself from feeling that pain again. Then there's Arjun, 28, who struggled to hold a job. His pattern was **predictable: procrastinate**, miss deadlines and eventually lose the role.

He believed he lacked discipline, but therapy uncovered a deeper truth. He had grown up under **relentless** criticism—nothing he did was ever good enough. That internalised voice followed him into adulthood, **leading him to self-sabotage** before anyone else could judge him. These aren't **isolated** stories. Many of us carry invisible wounds from our childhood.

A parent's absence, constant comparisons, or even a single harsh word can create emotional patterns—fear of **intimacy**, **perfectionism**, or **shrinking** ourselves to avoid rejection. Over time, these patterns create **setbacks** that seem external but are deeply internal. Therapy is where this cycle ends. It's not about blaming our parents or reliving the past. It's about understanding why we feel stuck and learning how to **let go** of the pain. Imagine carrying a heavy bag for years, thinking it's just part of life—then discovering you can put it down. That's what healing feels like.

One client described the process beautifully: "For the first time, I understand myself. I'm not broken. I've just been carrying pain I didn't know was there." Your **setbacks** aren't failures; they're signals that something inside you needs attention. Healing childhood wounds allows you to stop reacting from a place of fear and start living from a place of freedom. It's not an easy journey, but it's one worth taking. The truth is, you deserved love and safety as a child, and you still do now.

Healing isn't about **erasing** the past—it's about **reclaiming** your future. If this **resonates**, consider giving yourself the gift of therapy. You're not broken—you're healing.

[Practice]

[Exercise]

@mocks_wallah

Vocabulary

1. **Often** (adverb) – Frequently, regularly, repeatedly, commonly अक्सर
2. **Trace back to** (phrase) – Originate from, stem from, be linked to से जुड़ना
3. **Wonder** (verb) – Think about, question, ponder, be curious आश्चर्य करना/सोचना
4. **Ache** (noun) – Pain, discomfort, distress, sorrow दर्द
5. **Scar** (noun) – Mark, wound, blemish, injury घाव/निशान
6. **Embarrass** (verb) – Humiliate, shame, make uncomfortable, disconcert शर्मिंदा करना
7. **Thrive** (verb) – Flourish, succeed, prosper, grow खुशहाल होना
8. **Eventually** (adverb) – Finally, in the end, ultimately, at last अंततः
9. **Abandonment** (noun) – Desertion, neglect, leaving behind, forsaking त्याग/छोड़ देना
10. **Stem from** (phrasal verb) – Originate, arise from, result from, derive from से उत्पन्न होना
11. **Predictable** (adjective) – Expected, foreseeable, likely, unsurprising पूर्वानुमानित
12. **Procrastinate** (noun) – Delay, postponement, hesitation, deferral टालना
13. **Relentless** (adjective) – Persistent, unyielding, constant, continuous अथक/कठोर
14. **Criticism** (noun) – Disapproval, censure, judgment, evaluation आलोचना
15. **Lead** (to) (verb) – Cause, result in, bring about, produce वजह बनना
16. **Self-sabotage** (noun) – Self-damage, self-harm, destructive behavior, self-defeating actions आत्म-नुकसान
17. **Isolated** (adjective) – Separated, alone, detached, solitary अलग-थलग
18. **Intimacy** (noun) – Closeness, familiarity, affection, warmth निकटता
19. **Perfectionism** (noun) – Striving for flawlessness, meticulousness, idealism, faultlessness पूर्णता का प्रयास
20. **Shrink** (verb) – Reduce, diminish, lessen, contract सिकुड़ना
21. **Setback** (noun) – Obstacle, difficulty, delay, hindrance अड़चन/अवरोध
22. **Let go** (phrase) – Release, relinquish, give up, stop holding on छोड़ देना
23. **Erase** (verb) – Remove, delete, obliterate, wipe out मिटाना
24. **Reclaim** (verb) – Retrieve, regain, recover, take back पुनः प्राप्त करना
25. **Resonate** (verb) – Connect with, strike a chord, relate to, echo गूँजना/संबंधित होना

Summary of the Editorial

1. **Unseen Impact:** Unresolved childhood wounds often cause struggles in adult life, affecting work, relationships, and self-worth.
2. **Root Cause:** Feelings of inadequacy or repeated failures often trace back to emotional scars from childhood experiences.
3. **Early Learning:** Childhood shapes how individuals learn to trust, love, and value themselves.
4. **Hidden Scars:** Even seemingly minor incidents, like harsh remarks from parents or teachers, can leave lasting emotional damage.
5. **Case Study - Radhika:** Despite career success, she struggled with relationships due to abandonment issues from her father leaving when she was six.
6. **Case Study - Arjun:** His career failures stemmed from internalized criticism, leading to self-sabotage out of fear of rejection.
7. **Emotional Patterns:** Negative childhood experiences create emotional patterns such as perfectionism, fear of intimacy, or withdrawal from social connections.
8. **Internal Battles:** Challenges in adult life may appear external but are deeply rooted in internal emotional wounds.
9. **Therapy's Role:** Therapy offers a way to break the cycle, not by blaming parents but by understanding and addressing the emotional impact of the past.
10. **Healing Process:** Healing involves acknowledging past wounds, letting go of emotional baggage, and learning healthier responses.
11. **Self-Awareness:** Understanding personal struggles as signals of unresolved pain is the first step toward healing.
12. **Reframing Pain:** Individuals are not inherently broken but may carry pain they have not yet processed.
13. **New Perspective:** Healing allows people to stop reacting from fear and live with emotional freedom.
14. **Journey of Healing:** Though challenging, the journey to emotional recovery is worthwhile and empowering.
15. **Future Hope:** Healing is about reclaiming a fulfilling future, recognizing that everyone deserves love, safety, and emotional well-being.